

Leave and Attendance Policy

Meridian Global Corp — Confidential Internal Document

****Meridian Global Corp - Leave and Attendance Policy****

****Effective Date:**** January 1, 2024

****Version:**** V2.1

****Document Owner:**** Human Resources Department

1.0 Policy Statement

Meridian Global Corp is committed to fostering a supportive work environment that promotes employee well-being and a healthy work-life balance. This policy outlines the various leave benefits and attendance expectations for all eligible employees, ensuring consistency, fairness, and compliance with applicable labor laws and regulations across our global operations.

2.0 Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all full-time employees of Meridian Global Corp. Part-time employees may be eligible for pro-rated leave benefits as per local regulations and their specific employment contracts. Where local statutory requirements or collective bargaining agreements provide superior benefits or specific mandates, those provisions will supersede this policy.

3.0 Types of Leave

3.1 Earned Leave (EL)

Earned Leave, also known as Annual Leave or Vacation Leave, provides employees with paid time off for rest, recreation, and personal activities.

* ****Accrual:**** Employees accrue 18 days of Earned Leave per calendar year. This leave accrues on a pro-rata basis monthly, with 1.5 days credited at the end of each completed month of service. New hires will begin accruing EL from their date of joining.

* ****Eligibility:**** All permanent full-time employees are eligible for EL.

3.2 Sick Leave (SL)

Sick Leave is provided for an employee's personal illness or injury, or for the care of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent) requiring direct care.

* **Allowance:** Employees are granted 10 days of Sick Leave per calendar year.

* **Medical Certificate:** For absences exceeding three (3) consecutive working days due to illness, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner is required. Meridian Global Corp reserves the right to request a medical certificate for any duration of sick leave.

3.3 Casual Leave (CL)

Casual Leave is intended for unforeseen personal or urgent matters that require a short absence from work.

* **Allowance:** Employees are granted 6 days of Casual Leave per calendar year.

* **Usage:** CL cannot be carried forward to the next calendar year. While advance notice is appreciated, shorter notice may be accepted due to unforeseen circumstances, subject to manager approval and operational needs.

3.4 Maternity Leave (ML)

Meridian Global Corp is committed to supporting new parents and provides comprehensive maternity benefits.

* **Duration:** Eligible female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of fully paid Maternity Leave.

* **Eligibility:** Employees must have completed at least 80 days of service with Meridian Global Corp in the 12 months immediately preceding the expected date of delivery.

* **Notice:** Employees should provide notice of their pregnancy and their intention to take maternity leave as early as possible, ideally by the end of the first trimester, to their HR Business Partner and immediate manager.

3.5 Paternity Leave (PL)

To support new fathers, Meridian Global Corp offers Paternity Leave.

* **Duration:** Eligible male employees are entitled to 5 working days of Paternity Leave.

* **Usage:** PL must be taken within three (3) months of the birth or adoption of a child.

* **Notice:** Employees must provide at least two (2) weeks' advance notice of their intention to take Paternity Leave to their HR Business Partner and manager, along with relevant supporting documentation (e.g., birth certificate).

4.0 Leave Accrual, Carry-Forward, and Expiry

* **EL Carry-Forward:** A maximum of 30 days of accrued Earned Leave can be carried forward from one calendar year to the next. Any EL balance exceeding 30 days at the end of the calendar year (December 31st) will automatically lapse and will not be carried forward or encashed, unless specifically mandated by local statutory regulations.

* **SL and CL Expiry:** Unused Sick Leave and Casual Leave expire at the end of each calendar year (December 31st) and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

5.0 Leave Encashment

Meridian Global Corp recognizes the value of accrued leave.

* **Eligibility:** Employees may apply to encash up to 15 days of their accrued Earned Leave per calendar year, provided they maintain a minimum balance of 10 days of EL after encashment.

* **Process:** Encashment requests must be submitted through the HR Portal (MyMeridian) and are subject to HR approval. Encashed leave days will be paid out at the employee's current basic salary rate. Encashment requests for the current year must be submitted no later than November 30th.

6.0 Leave Application Procedure

All leave requests must be submitted and approved through the Meridian Global Corp HR Portal (MyMeridian).

* **Planned Leave (EL, ML, PL):** Employees are required to submit leave requests for planned absences, such as Earned Leave, Maternity Leave, and Paternity Leave, at least seven (7) calendar days in advance. Longer notice periods are highly encouraged for extended leaves to allow for proper resource planning.

* **Unplanned Leave (SL, CL):** For Sick Leave or Casual Leave, employees must inform their immediate manager verbally or via email as soon as possible on the first day of absence, followed by a formal request via the HR Portal within 24 hours.

* **Approval:** All leave requests require the approval of the immediate manager. HR Business Partners may also need to approve certain leave types, especially for extended periods or specific benefits (e.g., Maternity Leave). Approval is subject to operational requirements and staffing levels.

7.0 Attendance Expectations

Employees are expected to maintain regular and punctual attendance. Any unauthorized absence from work will be considered a breach of this policy and may lead to disciplinary action. Employees are responsible for notifying their manager of any potential delays or absences in a timely manner.

8.0 Non-Compliance and Policy Review

Failure to adhere to the terms of this Leave and Attendance Policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, in accordance with Meridian Global Corp's Disciplinary Policy. This policy will be reviewed periodically, at least every two years, or as necessitated by changes in legislation or company operational requirements. Any updates will be communicated promptly to all employees.